

THE DARK HIERARCHY

A Metaphysics of Desire, Authority, and Bodily Custody

ECHO KRONBORG · CARRIER OF DECHO · BERLIN

Desire is not only what you feel toward another person, but what you feel about yourself in their presence.

A completed work of erotic philosophy, speculative theology, and field testimony that challenges the Lacanian doctrine of lack from inside lived hierarchical practice. Five books and a coda, typeset as a 6 × 9 in trade volume, with a seven-instrument digital companion that gives every reader a private way back into the argument.

381 PAGES	67,310 WORDS	5 + Coda BOOKS
21 MOVEMENTS	7 INSTRUMENTS	37 SCHOLARLY NOTES

The audience is measurable, and large

Independent research and event data show that the book’s subject is not a fringe curiosity. Third-party figures below are market context, with sources on page 2; they are not projections for this title.

46.8%

OF BELGIAN ADULTS

had performed at least one BDSM-related activity; 12.5% do so regularly and 7.6% self-identify as practitioners.¹

45.6%

OF QUEBEC ADULTS

reported interest in at least one behaviour DSM-5 classes as atypical; 33% had experienced one (n = 1,040).²

20,000+

FOLSOM EUROPE, BERLIN

visitors expected at the 2025 edition, up from about 3,500 at the first, per the organiser.³

16,600

DARKLANDS, ANTWERP

admissions sold in presale for 2024, with 437 performers and 290 vendors.⁴

8-11M

FETLIFE ACCOUNTS

estimated registered members worldwide. Figures vary by source and are not independently audited.⁵

165M+

FIFTY SHADES, COPIES

sold worldwide per its publisher: proof of mass readership for the subject, in a very different register.⁶

Six story angles for press

- “Against Lacan, from inside the dungeon.” A theory book that tests its argument against lived practice rather than the clinic.
- A book with a private companion. Seven instruments, local-first storage, no analytics, and an 18+ gate: the opposite of a data-harvesting app.
- The author audits himself. The book is “not a confession; it is version control,” and its twentieth movement analyses the author’s own relationship record.
- “God has two neighbors: Order and Humor.” Bergman’s dictum turned into a household philosophy: quotable, funny, serious.
- Berlin as a leather capital. A natural partner for Folsom Europe week and the city’s fetish and queer cultural calendar.
- Consent as theology. Revocability and autonomy are stated as preconditions on page one, answering the “is this safe?” question before it is asked.

Programming and partnerships

- Reading series and philosophy nights built around single movements: the 21-movement structure is modular.
- Festival and gallery talks in the Folsom Europe and Darklands orbit, subject to invitation and partner programming.
- University adoption: a 15-week graduate syllabus (Philosophy / GSWS) is included in the proposal kit.
- Instrument-led workshops: each of the seven tools is a 5–12 minute reflective exercise (115 prompts in total) that can anchor a session.

What the product team can expect

Is the manuscript finished?

Yes. Release edition v122, 381 pages, 0 errors and 0 undefined references in the last clean two-pass build. Full PDF on request.

Is there a digital product to launch with?

Yes, live at echoxstudios.art/tdh: seven instruments, shareable partner comparison, private retrieval codes, optional emailed results.

Is it responsibly built?

Adults only; local-first by default; cross-device storage only on explicit consent; no marketing cookies; no result statistics sent for analytics; non-diagnostic by design.

What we do not claim. No clinical validity. No sales forecast. No claim that the Echo-System has collected research data, or that the reference overlay is a census. Third-party figures describe the wider field, not this title’s expected reach.

SOURCES, ACCESSED 2 OCTOBER 2026

- Holvoet L. et al., “Fifty Shades of Belgian Gray: The Prevalence of BDSM-Related Fantasies and Activities in the General Population,” *Journal of Sexual Medicine*, 2017. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/28781214
- Joyal C.C. & Carpentier J., “The Prevalence of Paraphilic Interests and Behaviors in the General Population: A Provincial Survey,” *Journal of Sex Research* 54(2), 2017. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/26941021; summary at eurekalert.org/news-releases/674264
- FolsomEurope e.V., via place2be.berlin/en/discover-berlin/folsom-europe-berlin-all-essential-informations-and-data (organiser figures).
- Darklands 2024 post-event report, tripbytrip.org/2024/03/08/darklands-2025-theme-darklands-glows-stays-at-waagnatie-until-2030
- FetLife membership: third-party estimates range from about 8 to 11 million registered accounts; self-reported, unaudited.
- Penguin Random House, Fifty Shades of Grey series page, penguinrandomhouse.com/series/FS3/fifty-shades-of-grey-series (“more than 165 million copies sold worldwide”).

Request the manuscript and submission package

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